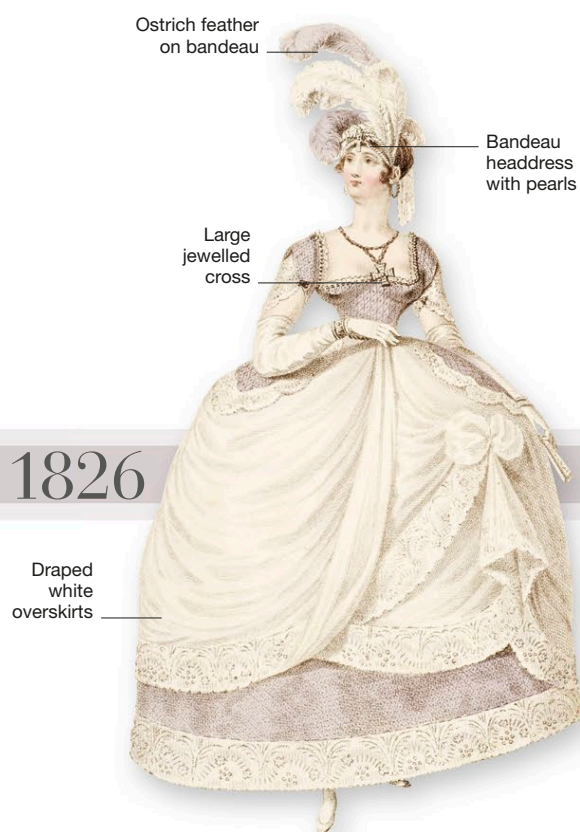


1820–1830

THE EVENING HOURGLASS

Key features of evening wear between 1820 and 1830 were the gradual appearance of very wide puffed sleeves and strong appliqué decoration. At the beginning of the 1820s dresses were simple and pale, with small puffed sleeves and some decoration around the hem of the full skirt. By the end of the decade they became shorter and puffed sleeves expanded, balancing the bell-shaped skirt and emphasizing the tiny, corseted waist. Appliqué decoration in self fabric and lattice work created three-dimensional layering on dresses, and realistic flower trimming on dresses was used as well as on hair adornments. Evening dresses had low décolletage necklines, which emphasized a bottle-shaped neck. The bare neck was often unadorned, or sometimes broad necklaces were worn. Hairstyles became elaborate, piled high on the head with sculptural shapes formed of bows and loops adorned with flowers, feathers, and jewels.



1826

1830

Court dress Underpinned by hoops, this dress was suitable for wearing at court (though hoops were banned by George IV in England). It has a squared décolletage and is accessorized with an elaborate bandeau.



Off-the-shoulder dress This silk dress has lantern-style puffed sleeves. Careful pleating on the bodice tucks into a low waistband. The skirt has a deep lattice overlay with diagonal piping, and ribbon bows.



1822

Parisian ball dress Skirts were now softly full. Fashionable materials included “gros de Naples” (Italian silk with a corded surface), and lutestring (a finer and shinier silk).



Tassel trimmings This unusual, silk dress is overlaid with spotted, silk ribbon. It has trellis fringing and plentiful tassels. There is a wide belt and ties and even wider shoulder epaulettes.